



Livestock Production Manual — Super Green Farm

 **Purpose:** Standardize livestock production at Super Green Farm to improve animal welfare, productivity, product quality, and biosecurity.

1) Scope & guiding principles

- Animal welfare first (good feed, clean water, comfort, prevention over treatment).
- Biosecurity is non-negotiable (control entry, clean/disinfect, isolate sick/new animals).
- Records drive decisions (production, health, breeding, feed, costs).
- Continuous improvement (review KPIs monthly; update SOPs).

2) Farm roles & responsibilities

- **Farm manager:** planning, KPIs, budgets, training, compliance.
- **Livestock supervisor:** daily operations, checklists, staff supervision.
- **Animal attendants:** feeding, watering, cleaning, observation, basic handling.
- **Vet/animal health provider (internal/contract):** herd health plans, treatments, training.
- **Store/warehouse:** inventory control for feed, drugs, PPE, cleaning supplies.

3) Farm layout (recommended)

- Reception/office (visitor log + PPE).

- Feed store (dry, vermin-proof) + forage area/silage pit.
- Animal housing by species/class (separate kids/calves/lambs/piglets/laying hens).
- Isolation/quarantine pens (away from main barns).
- Manure/compost zone (downwind, controlled runoff).
- Loading/handling area (race/chute, crush, scales).
- Water points with easy cleaning.

4) Biosecurity program (SOP)

4.1 Entry control

- Keep a single main entrance.
- Visitor log: name, contact, purpose, last farm visited.
- Provide farm boots/boot dips and clean coveralls.
- No entry to animal areas without authorization.

4.2 Quarantine & isolation

- **New animals:** quarantine 14–30 days.
- **Sick animals:** isolate immediately.
- Separate tools for quarantine (buckets, shovels, brushes).

4.3 Cleaning & disinfection

- Remove organic matter first (scrape/wash) then disinfect.
- Footbaths: refresh daily (or when dirty).
- Rodent control: bait stations + sanitation.

4.4 Movement control

- Work order: **young** → **adults** → **sick/quarantine (last)**.

5) Animal sourcing & receiving

5.1 Purchase criteria

- Buy from known farms with health history.
- Choose animals with:
 - bright eyes, normal breathing, no nasal discharge
 - good body condition, no lameness
 - clean coat/skin, no external parasites
 - normal manure, good appetite

5.2 Receiving checklist

- Identify/tag each animal.
- Weigh (or estimate) and record.
- Temperature check if suspected illness.
- Deworm/external parasite control as per vet plan.
- Vaccination review and schedule.
- Place in quarantine.

6) Housing standards (general)

- Provide adequate space, ventilation, shade, and dry bedding.
- Keep floors non-slippery; drainage away from pens.
- Separate by age/sex/production stage to reduce stress and disease.
- Provide clean water at all times.

6.1 Bedding & hygiene

- Replace wet bedding daily in young-stock pens.
- Deep-litter systems: add dry bedding regularly; remove and compost periodically.

7) Nutrition & feeding management

7.1 Core rules

- Feed quality matters more than quantity.
- Provide **clean water 24/7**.
- Introduce diet changes gradually over 7–14 days.
- Use feed troughs to reduce waste and contamination.

7.2 Feed plan template (fill per species)

- **Production goal:** (e.g., milk/day, weight gain, eggs/day)
- **Daily ration:** forage + concentrate + minerals
- **Minerals/salt:** always available (block/loose)
- **Feeding times:** morning / afternoon

7.3 Pasture & forage

- Rotate grazing to prevent overgrazing and parasite build-up.
- Provide shade and water in grazing areas.
- Make hay/silage at the right stage for best quality.

8) Water management

- Test water source periodically if possible.
- Clean troughs daily (scrub algae and manure).
- Ensure adequate flow/pressure.

9) Breeding & reproduction

9.1 Breeding objectives

- Improve fertility, growth, milk/egg yield, disease resistance, temperament.

9.2 Heat detection (general)

- Restlessness, mounting, reduced feed intake, vocalization.
- Record heat dates to predict next heat and due dates.

9.3 Mating systems

- **Natural mating:** control male-to-female ratio; rotate males.
- **AI (if used):** trained staff, clean handling, accurate heat detection.

9.4 Pregnancy & parturition

- Separate late-pregnant females into maternity pens.
- Prepare clean bedding and calving/kidding/lambing kit.
- Assist only when necessary; keep hygiene strict.

9.5 Newborn care (first hours)

- Clear airway; dry the newborn.
- Ensure colostrum intake as soon as possible.
- Dip navel (iodine) to prevent infection.
- Record birth, dam, sex, weight.

10) Health management

10.1 Daily health observation (every pen)

- Appetite and water intake
- Behavior (alertness)
- Breathing/coughing
- Body condition
- Manure consistency
- Lameness/injuries

10.2 Vaccination & deworming

- Follow a vet-approved schedule based on local disease risks.
- Avoid routine deworming without need where possible; use targeted treatments.

10.3 Common disease response (SOP)

1. Isolate animal.
2. Notify supervisor/manager.
3. Check temperature and record symptoms.
4. Provide supportive care (water, shade, easy feed).
5. Treat only with approved protocols; record drug, dose, withdrawal period.
6. Disinfect area and tools.

10.4 Medicines & withdrawal periods

- Store drugs locked, cool, and dry.
- Keep an updated drug register.
- Observe withdrawal periods for milk, meat, and eggs.

11) Handling, welfare & safety

- Use calm, low-stress handling.
- Never beat animals; use sorting boards/flags where applicable.
- Train staff on:
 - safe restraint
 - lifting techniques
 - zoonotic disease precautions
- PPE: gloves, boots, masks when needed.

12) Production modules (species-specific SOPs)

Use the sections below for whichever livestock Super Green Farm keeps.
Remove what you don't use.

12A) Dairy cattle (if applicable)

Milking hygiene

- Wash hands and use clean towels.
- Pre-dip teats (if used), wipe dry, strip-test.
- Milk in a calm routine; avoid stress.
- Post-dip teats after milking.

Milk handling

- Filter milk; cool quickly.
- Clean cans/milking machine immediately after use.

Mastitis control

- Identify early (clots, swelling).
- Separate and milk last.

12B) Beef cattle

- Growth monitoring: weigh/estimate monthly.
- Fattening ration with gradual changes.
- Control ticks/parasites.

12C) Goats (meat and/or dairy)

- Keep pens dry; goats are sensitive to damp conditions.
- Provide browse/roughage + minerals.
- Kids: ensure colostrum; manage coccidiosis risk.

12D) Sheep

- Foot care and hoof trimming schedule.

- Parasite control tied to grazing rotation.
- Lambing pens kept clean and warm.

12E) Pigs

- Strong biosecurity (high disease risk).
- Temperature control for piglets (warmth).
- All-in/all-out pen management when possible.
- Clean water nipples and avoid feed spoilage.

12F) Poultry (broilers/layers)

Broilers

- Temperature and ventilation management.
- Litter kept dry; prevent ammonia.
- Clean drinkers daily.

Layers

- Provide nest boxes and clean egg collection trays.
- Collect eggs 2–3 times/day.
- Store eggs cool, clean, and dry.

13) Manure management & environmental care

- Remove manure regularly and compost.
- Keep manure away from water sources.
- Use composted manure on crops (reduces pathogens and improves soil).
- Control flies: sanitation + traps.

14) Recordkeeping (minimum required)

14.1 Registers

- Animal inventory (ID, breed, sex, DOB, source)
- Production (milk/egg/weight gain)
- Breeding (heat, mating/AI, pregnancy, births)
- Health (treatments, vaccinations, deaths)
- Feed inventory and costs
- Sales (animals, milk, eggs)

14.2 Daily log (template)

- Date:
- Staff on duty:
- Feed issued (type/qty):
- Water check completed (Y/N):
- Cleaning completed (Y/N):
- Sick/injured animals:
- Treatments given:
- Mortalities:
- Notes/issues:

15) KPIs (review monthly)

- Mortality rate (young and adult)
- Average daily gain (meat animals)
- Milk per animal per day (dairy)
- Egg production rate (layers)
- Feed conversion ratio (where applicable)
- Treatment rate and major disease events
- Pregnancy rate / kidding-calving-lambing interval

16) Emergency procedures

16.1 Disease outbreak

- Stop animal movement.
- Isolate affected groups.
- Contact vet/animal health authority if required.
- Increase disinfection and PPE.

16.2 Fire/flood/extreme heat

- Evacuation plan + safe holding area.
- Ensure backup water.
- Heat stress: shade, ventilation, extra water, reduce handling.

17) Review & updates

- Review this manual every 6 months or after any major incident.
 - Record changes and train staff on updates.
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Appendix A — Basic stock kits

- Thermometer
- Disinfectant + sprayer
- Gloves, boots, masks
- Iodine for navels
- Record sheets/clipboard
- First aid supplies (as approved)

Appendix B — Signs that need urgent attention

- Not eating/drinking
- Severe diarrhea or blood in stool

- Labored breathing
- High fever
- Unable to stand
- Sudden death in a group